

History of Computers

Learning Objectives

- Identify major generations of computers
- Explain how computers have changed over time
- Compare early computers with modern ones

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Your grandmother might tell you how she used to grind grain by hand, then got a hand mill, and now uses an electric grinder. Computers changed the same way—from room-sized machines to devices in your pocket. Let us trace this journey through time.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Look at pictures of early computers like ENIAC and modern laptops. Create a simple timeline on paper showing four stages: 1940s room-sized computers, 1970s desktop computers, 1990s laptops, and today's smartphones. Write one feature of each stage.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Computers evolved through generations. First-generation used vacuum tubes and filled entire rooms. Second-generation used transistors and got smaller. Third-generation used microchips and became personal. Today's computers are powerful, portable, and connected through networks.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Your family might own a smartphone more powerful than early computers that guided rockets. Write a short paragraph comparing what a 1960s computer could do versus your phone today. Discuss with a partner how this change affects your studies.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name two ways modern computers are different from early ones. Draw a quick sketch of the oldest and newest computer you can think of.